

Yunhao (Derek) Li

ORCID: 0009-0007-3854-8409

Emails: yunhao.li@yale.edu & derek.yunhao.li@gmail.com

Personal Website: derek-yunhao-li.github.io

EDUCATION

- 2024 – Present Ph.D. student in Assyriology, Yale University
Affiliation: Department of Near Eastern Languages & Civilizations
Research interests: economic and financial history, childhood studies
- 2024 B.A. in Economics & B.A. in History, Peking University
Affiliation: National School of Development
Advisor: Yiling Zhao ([link](#))
Thesis: *“Boll Weevil Everywhere”: Impacts of Boll Weevil on Agriculture and Higher Education in the U.S. South (1892–1922)*

ACADEMIC VISITING

- Aug 2022 – Dec 2022 International Guest Student, University of Pennsylvania

ACADEMIC SERVICE & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Mar 2025 – Aug 2026 Museum Assistant for Yale Babylonian Collection, Yale Peabody Museum
- May 2023 – Feb 2024 Research Assistant for Yiling Zhao (Peking University)
- Oct 2021 – Aug 2022 Research Assistant for Sophie Calder-Wang (UPenn) & Jinglin Li (Harvard)
- Jul 2021 – Dec 2021 Research Assistant for Jinglin Li (Harvard)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Yale University

- Fall 2026 NELC 1330/5170 “Beginnings of Business: A History of Early Trade,” teaching fellow (instructor: Gojko Barjamovic)

Peking University

Spring 2024	“International Trade,” teaching assistant (instructor: Qingyang Huang)
Summer 2023	“Visual Communication for a Global World,” teaching assistant (instructor: Laurence Simmons [University of Auckland])

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

Feb 6, 2026	“Reassessing the mechanism of Old Assyrian <i>naruqqum</i> -partnership.” <i>NELC Roundtable</i> . Yale University. (link)
Apr 4–5, 2025	Session Chair. <i>Landscapes and Environments of the Ancient Near East: The 7th Graduate Symposium in Ancient Near Eastern Studies</i> . Yale University. (link)

SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

2024	Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award (National School of Development, Peking University)
2024	Distinguished Thesis Award (Peking University)
2023	Rainbow Bridge Alumni Scholarship
2023	Award for Academic Excellence (Peking University)
2023	Deng Guangming Academic Paper Award (Department of History, Peking University)
2020	Freshman Scholarship (Peking University)

OTHERS

Programming skills & software:

LaTeX, Markdown, MATLAB, Python, QGIS, Stata

Languages:

Modern Languages: Chinese (native), English (proficient), French & German (reading knowledge)

Ancient Languages: Akkadian, Sumerian